

## Procedure- Risk of impartiality analysis

1. **Purpose:** The purpose of this procedure is to establish a systematic process for identifying, analysing, evaluating, reating, monitoring and documenting risks to impartiality arising from the activities, relationships and circumstances of the Certification Body (CB) BVSP.
2. **Scope:** This procedure applies to all certification activities performed by the CB.
  - Top management and certification personnel.
  - Internal and external auditors.
  - Technical experts and subcontracted personnel.
  - Certification decision-makers.
  - Committees involved in certification activities.
  - Sales and marketing personnel.
  - Consultants or organizations having a relationship with the CB.
  - Owners, directors and other persons who may influence certification activities.
  - The procedure covers actual, potential and perceived threats to impartiality.
3. **Reference:**
  - ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 5.2 – Management of Impartiality.
  - ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 5.3 – Liability and Financing.
  - ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 6.1 – Organizational Structure.
  - Applicable IAF Mandatory Documents and accreditation-body requirements.
  - BVSP policies, procedures and contractual requirements.
4. **Responsibility:** Top Management and Quality manager /Technical Manager/ Impartiality Committee
5. **Types of Impartiality Threats:** The CB(BVSP) shall consider, as applicable, the following sources of risk:

| Threat Type           | Example                                                     |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Self-interest         | Financial interest in a client                              |
| Familiarity           | Auditor becoming overly familiar with a client              |
| Advocacy              | CB/person promoting the client's interests                  |
| Commercial pressure   | Pressure to retain or obtain a client                       |
| Personal relationship | Auditor has family/friend relationship with client          |
| Ownership             | Common ownership between CB and clien                       |
| Consultancy           | related organization provides management-system consultancy |
| Training              | Training provided to the client by certification personnel  |
| Shared resources      | Shared personnel, premises or systems with consultancy      |

|             |                                                           |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Outsourcing | Audit activities outsourced to a consultancy organization |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|

6. **Risk Assessment Methodology:** each impartiality risk based on Likelihood and Impact.

Risk Score = Likelihood × Impact

| Likelihood                  | Impact                                        |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 1 – Low: Unlikely to happen | 1 – Low: Little or no effect on impartiality  |
| 2 – Medium: May happen      | 2 – Medium: Could affect impartiality         |
| 3 – High: Likely to happen  | 3 – High: Could seriously affect impartiality |

#### Risk Rating

| Score | Risk Level | Action                                                   |
|-------|------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| 1–2   | Low        | Accept and monitor                                       |
| 3–4   | Medium     | Take appropriate control action                          |
| 6–9   | High       | Immediate action required; eliminate or control the risk |

7.0 **Impartiality Risk Assessment Process:** The process shall consist of the following steps:

**Identify → Analyse → Evaluate → Treat → Approve → Monitor → Review**

7.1 Identification:

- Risks shall be identified from:
- New clients.
- Existing client relationships.
- Personnel appointments.
- Auditor assignment.
- Changes in ownership.
- Financial arrangements.
- Marketing activities.
- Training activities.

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- Consultancy relationships.
- Subcontracting.
- Incidents or allegations of bias.
- Changes in organizational structure.
- Feedback from interested parties.

## 7.2 Analysis

- For each threat, the CB shall determine:
- Source of the threat.
- Person/activity/relationship involved.
- Likelihood.
- Consequence.
- Existing safeguards.
- Initial risk rating.
- Additional controls required.
- Residual risk.

## 7.3 Evaluation: The CB shall determine whether the residual risk is acceptable.

- Where the risk remains unacceptable, the CB shall:
- Eliminate the relationship/activity; or
- Introduce additional safeguards; or
- Remove the affected person; or
- Reassign the audit/decision activity; or
- Refuse/prohibit the certification activity where necessary.

## 8. Risk Treatment / Controls

- Examples of safeguards include:
- Conflict-of-interest declaration before assignment.
- Independent review of auditor assignment.
- Rotation of auditors where appropriate.
- Separation of sales and certification decision-making.
- Independent certification decision process.
- Prohibition of management-system consultancy.
- Restrictions on gifts and hospitality.
- Declaration of financial/personal interests.
- Independent review of high-risk certification decisions.
- Separation of training and certification activities where necessary.
- Monitoring of relationships with consultancy organizations.

|                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
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|                                                                                  | <p align="center"><b>Procedure- Risk of impartially analysis</b></p>                                                                                                                    |

- Two-year restrictions where required by ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015.
- Impartiality Committee review.
- Removal/replacement of personnel presenting unacceptable conflicts.

#### 9.0 Special Mandatory Controls

- BVSP not provide management-system consultancy to certification clients.
- Internal auditing activities that create a significant threat are controlled in accordance with ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015.
- Personnel who have provided relevant management-system consultancy are not assigned to the affected client contrary to the applicable two-year restriction.
- Audits are not outsourced to management-system consultancy organizations where prohibited.
- Certification decisions remain independent of commercial considerations.
- Unacceptable impartiality threats result in prohibition of the affected certification activity.

#### 10. Record:

| Record                                           | Responsibility | Retention |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------------|-----------|
| BVSP-A-21 – Risk of Impartiality Analysis Result | QM/TM          | 3 years   |
| <i>BVSP-F-38 Impartiality Risk Record</i>        | QM/TM          | 3 years   |

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